

Popular books that are overrated!!!

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Jul 20, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/QhUb7OKeCyQ> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Brandon Carter dismisses four widely praised books as merely "fine" or inapplicable, then recommends three alternatives he considers genuinely transformative for mindset, relationships, and entrepreneurship.

Contents

-  Overrated Books
-  Recommended Books

Overrated Books 0:00

- **The Alchemist**
 - Widely praised but Carter's verdict: "it was fine" — not as great as the hype suggests
- **The 7 Habits of Highly Effective People**
 - Also rated "fine" — "wasn't life-changing information for me at least"
- **The Power of Now**
 - Many people love it, but Carter initially couldn't get past the first chapter
 - His sticking point: the author describes becoming enlightened and then sitting on a park bench "not making money for hours a day" and being in bliss
 - Carter's reaction: "No, I don't want to end up like that"
 - He did eventually pick it up later in life and read through it — called it "fun and good"
- **Good to Great**
 - Acknowledged as a good book, but Carter argues it won't be applicable for most entrepreneurs starting a small business

Recommended Books 0:47

- **Relentless** by Tim Grover
 - Carter calls it "probably one of my favorite books" — he liked it so much he had it tattooed on his arm
 - Tim Grover was the personal trainer for Michael Jordan, Kobe Bryant, and Dwyane Wade
 - The book covers the mindset required to accomplish extreme success
- **How to Win Friends and Influence People**

- One of Carter's definitive favorites
- His take: "the world would be a way better place if we forced high school students to read it"
- Best use cases: sales, marketing, and personal relationships — "probably not a better book to read" for those goals
- **Ready, Fire, Aim** (business book)
 - Breaks down exactly what you need to do at every level of your business to advance to the next level
 - Carter calls it "a powerful book" and recommends it to any entrepreneur

"I think the world would be a way better place if we forced high school students to read [How to Win Friends and Influence People]."